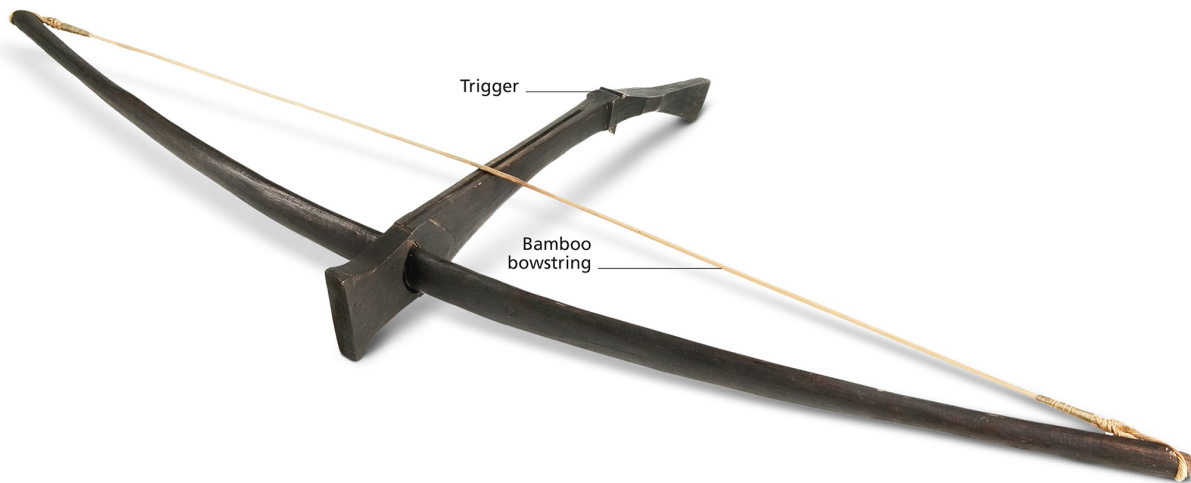




Green Beret advisers

Members of the Green Berets show Montagnard tribesmen how to operate a 57 mm recoilless rifle so that they can defend their village against Viet Cong attack.



Montagnard crossbow

Usually used for hunting, crossbows were also employed as weapons during the war. They were carved from tropical timber and fired bamboo arrows.

Organized rebellion

Not all Montagnards supported the US against the communists. The relationship was complicated by the Montagnards' hatred of the South Vietnamese regime. The Special Forces therefore spent a large proportion of their time in the early days winning the Montagnards' trust and dissuading them from defecting to the Viet Cong. When the military junta that replaced Diem in 1963 pursued ever-more repressive policies against the Montagnards, rebellion ensued, spearheaded by an ethnonationalist movement—the United Front for the Liberation of Oppressed Races (FULRO).

In September 1964, some 3,000 Montagnards in five Special Forces camps in the Central Highlands killed 80 South Vietnamese troops and took 20 Americans hostage. Eventually, Special Forces officers persuaded the rebels to lay down their arms. The FULRO